

PRESS RELEASE

150 years of Bangalore Golf Club- Promoting Inclusivity through Golf **For First Time in India -Golf Tournament for Persons with Disabilities** **In Collaboration with Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation**

For the first time in India, a golf tournament is being conducted for persons with disabilities. The 1st India Adaptive Golf Open 2026 will be held at Bangalore Golf Club, on 2nd and 3rd June 2026.

Captain of BGC, Mr. Ravi Kumar Raju said that the golf club, which is celebrating 150 years, has always promoted the cause of Golf and encouraged the growth of the game. As a special initiative, for its 150th year, the club, a leader in India, is proud to host the first tournament for persons with disability. The initiative in collaboration with Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation is part of the social outreach of Bangalore Golf Club that promotes inclusivity through Golf.

Mr. Chandrashekar Kini, Director of Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation said that the organization is very pleased to conduct the 1st India Adaptive Open. He said that this initiative was only possible with the encouragement and very gracious support of Bangalore Golf Club. AGAF, a Sec 8 (non-profit) Company, set up only 6 months ago to promote golf for the disabled, has made great strides in initiating Adaptive Golf in India. The organization has successfully put in place signal initiatives to introduce the disabled to golf, train coaches to support disabled players and support the growth of golf players with disability. The 1st India Adaptive Golf Open is the first step to establish a competitive platform in India that will help players with disability grow and compete on equal terms with players across the world.

The tournament will see 19 players with a range of disabilities compete on both regular formats for players with experience and a fun format for those recently initiated into Golf. To qualify for participation in the tournament a player must hold an EDGA Player Pass issued by EDGA Golf assigning the appropriate disability classification and applicable section of Rule 25 of the Rules of Golf. Through the work of Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation EDGA Player Pass holders in India have rapidly grown in just 5 months from 3 to 26.

The field for the 1st India Adaptive Golf Open 2026, will include visually impaired and blind players, disabilities from amputations or limb deficiencies

and includes an officer of our armed forces injured in action while defending our country. The player stories reveal grit and determination.

Players who compete would build their future as Adaptive Golfers and can go on to acquire and build a world ranking. Apart from supporting India participation in overseas tournaments, Adaptive Golf Alliance is working towards conduct of tournaments in India, approved by EDGA Golf to qualify for WR4GD (World Ranking for Golfers with Disability) points.

Two India players have been nominated by AGAF to compete at the Czech Disabled Masters 2026 at Prague between 23rd and 26th June 26. This initiative has been generously supported by Genesis IT Innovations. Ankush Saha from Bangalore and Vishwa Vardhan Bhati from NOIDA, who are also participating at the 1st India Adaptive Golf Open 2026, will travel to Prague. Vishwa Vardhan Bhati is ranked 179 (Stableford) as on 25th May 26.

Mr Kini said that India has visible talent for Adaptive Golf, Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation looks forward to supporting Adaptive Golf players from India and help make them a familiar sight at international competitions in the next few years. He was confident that they would acquit themselves well.

Golf is one of the most inclusive sports and embraces players of all abilities. The introduction of Rule 25 in the Rules of Golf in 2023, eased the participation of the disabled in the sport. Over 70 tournaments for the disabled are conducted across the world, largely in Europe and USA, administered by EDGA Golf (formerly the European Disabled Golf Association), The R&A and The USGA. The leading tournaments in the world are the G4D Open conducted by The R&A and DP World Tour and the US Adaptive Open conducted by the USGA

Through crucial support at formative stages by Golf Clubs like BGC with high reputation and long history, and nurturing by Adaptive Golf Alliance Foundation, India is now making a visible entrance into Adaptive Golf.